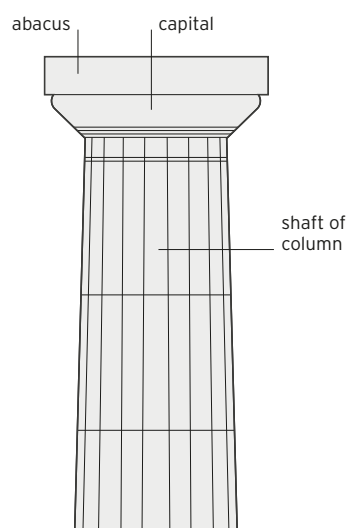


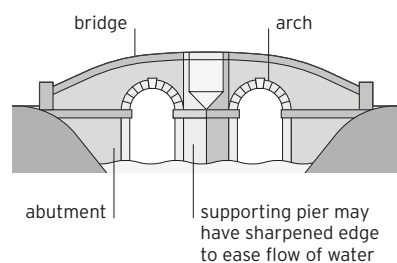
GLOSSARY

A

ABACUS ▼ A flat slab forming the topmost part of a column. Typically wider than the capital on which it sits, the abacus receives the weight of the structure above the column, usually an arch or architrave. *See also* arch, architrave, capital, column.



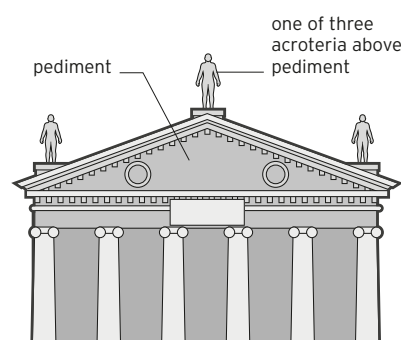
ABUTMENT ▼ The substructure on which a superstructure rests. Abutments are typically found at the ends of bridges or either side of arches, transferring horizontal and vertical loads to the foundation.



ACANTHUS A flowering plant native to warm regions, particularly the Mediterranean. In ancient Greek architecture, acanthus leaves often appear as an

ornamental pattern on capitals of the Corinthian order. *See also* Corinthian, order.

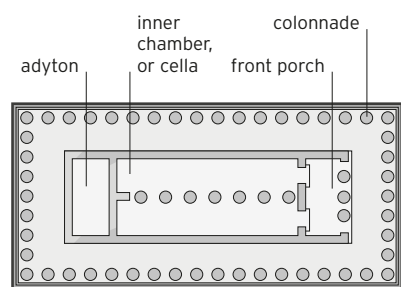
ACROPOLIS The fortified part of an ancient Greek city, typically built on a hill. The most famous example is the Acropolis of Athens, site of the Parthenon.



ACROTHERION ▲ A decorative sculpture or ornament at the apex or ends of a pediment. Originally, acroteria were often petal-shaped ornaments; later they developed into statues or groups of statues.

ACRYLIC A type of plastic. It is often used in architecture as a substitute for glass in high-pressure, high-impact scenarios such as for skylights and underwater.

ADOBE Sun-dried mud-brick used for building. Adobe often contains chopped straw to reinforce the mixture of compressed earth and clay.



ADYTON ▲ The innermost sanctuary within a Greek or Roman temple. The adyton (*adytum* in

Latin) often housed the cult image of the god, and entry was forbidden except to priests.

AESTHETIC Relating to the notion of beauty and good taste. The Aesthetic Movement was prominent in 19th-century European art, which valued beauty above all other qualities.

AGGREGATE Fragments or particles loosely compacted together. A coarse aggregate of sand, gravel, and crushed stone is an essential component of concrete. *See also* concrete.

AIR CONDITIONING A mechanical air-cooling system. Air conditioning can refer to any technology that modifies air in a closed environment by cooling, heating, dehumidifying, cleaning, or ventilating.

AISLE A lengthwise corridor or wing that typically runs parallel to the nave in a church. Aisles often have a roof at a lower level than the nave. An aisle may also be a passage between rows of seats in a building or the passage between shelving or storage such as in a supermarket or warehouse. *See also* church, nave.

ALABASTER A light-colored, translucent, soft stone. Alabaster has historically been favored by sculptors for small, decorative items because it is easy to work.

ALCOVE A small, arched recess in a room or external wall.

ALTAR A flat-topped table or block used as the focus for a religious ritual.

ALTAR-TOMB A raised tomb or funerary monument covering

a tomb that resembles an altar. These tombs are not used as altars; they only resemble them.

AMBULATORY A round walkway encircling the altar in a cathedral or large church. The term can also refer to the covered passage around a cloister. *See also* altar, church, cloister.

AMPHITHEATER A round-shaped open-air theater. Developed by the ancient Romans, amphitheaters were free-standing buildings, circular or oval in plan, with tiered seating all around a central arena.

ANASTYLOSIS The rebuilding of historical monuments using only the original elements. Components must be placed back in their original positions, and new materials can only be introduced if they are necessary for stability.

ANG A feature in Chinese roof construction; this is a long bracket arm that functions like a lever.

ANTECHURCH The portico at the main entrance to a church, also known as a narthex. *See also* church, narthex, portico.

APEX STONE *See* keystone.

APSE A semicircular recess covered with a hemispherical vault. In a church or cathedral, there is often an apse behind the altar. *See also* altar, cathedral, church, vault.

AQUEDUCT A bridge for conveying a water course. Aqueducts usually span valleys or ravines. They are particularly associated with the Romans, who built many notable examples.